

Every Day a Little More

Three weeks pass. Andrea goes to the gym every day. In the morning, before work. Every day.

She learns new words. Squat. Push. Pull. She learns how to use the machines. It is not easy, but she tries.

One day, a woman speaks to her.

"Hello! My name is Lucia. I am new here. Can you help me?"

Andrea smiles. "Of course! I was new too, not long ago."

Lucia and Andrea train together. They laugh. They work hard. They become good friends.

Every week, Andrea feels a little stronger. Her arms are bigger. Her legs are strong. She can lift more weight now.

One morning, she sees a sign on the wall:

GYM COMPETITION — Next Month. Who can lift the most in their group?

Andrea reads the sign two times. Her heart beats fast.

"I want to do this," she thinks.

She writes her name on the list.